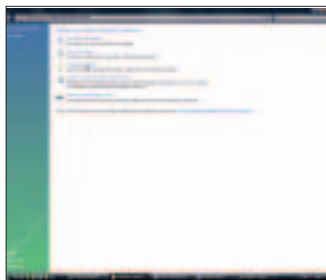


thing looks okay, open the **Recording** tab as described in Step 2, then double-click the microphone icon to open the **Properties** box. Click the **Levels** tab. If the button with the speaker icon on it has a red circle with a line through it, this means your settings are on mute. Click the button to take off mute. Also check the position of the **Microphone Slider** — if it's too far to the left, then drag and drop it to the right to increase your mic's volume. Click **OK** > **OK** again and start Step 3 again.

Step 5

Back in the **Speech Recognition Options** box, click the 'Take Speech Tutorial' box. It is imperative that you do the tutorial before you start to use the speech recognition software. Not only do you learn which commands to use, but while you are doing the training the software is learning how you pronounce words. This means it is more likely to understand you when you begin to use speech recognition. Click or say 'Next' and then 'Next' again. Follow the on-screen instructions until you have completed the tutorial.



Step 6

You can use speech recognition to navigate around your computer, surf the net using Internet Explorer, send emails in Windows Mail, or type documents in Word. If you get stuck, say, 'What can I say?' To stop speech recognition say, 'Stop listening' and start it up again by saying 'Start listening'. Speak clearly and slowly. It doesn't notice coughs, though a giggle makes it ask, 'What's that'? It does not understand you as well as during the tutorial, so it is worth taking the extra training course. Click **Start** > **Control Panel** > **Ease of Access** > then **Speech Recognition**. Click the 'Train your computer to better understand you' link, press **Next** and follow the steps.

